

Silent Night, Holy Night

Text: Joseph Mohr, 1818;
tr. John Freeman Young, 1863
STILLE NACHT irregular

Music: Franz Gruber, 1818



The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 6/8 time, featuring a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is divided into three systems, each with four measures. Above each measure, a guitar chord diagram is provided, showing the fretting and picking patterns. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words in italics. The first system contains the opening lines of the hymn, the second system contains the middle lines, and the third system contains the closing lines. The score concludes with a double bar line.

System 1:

- Chord 1: A-flat (4 1 3 2)
- Chord 2: E-flat (2 3 1)
- Chord 3: A-flat (4 1 3 2)

1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm, all is bright,
2 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Shep - herds quake at the sight,
3 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Son of God, love's pure light,
4 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Won - drous star, lend thy light,

System 2:

- Chord 1: D-flat (1 1 1 4)
- Chord 2: A-flat (4 1 3 2)
- Chord 3: D-flat (1 1 1 4)
- Chord 4: A-flat (4 1 3 2)

round yon vir - gin moth - er and child, ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild,
glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far, heav'n - ly hosts sing: "Al - le - lu - ia,
ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face, with the dawn of re - deem - ing grace,
with the an - gels let us sing, Al - le - lu - ia to our King,

System 3:

- Chord 1: E-flat (2 3 1)
- Chord 2: A-flat (4 1 3 2)
- Chord 3: E-flat (2 3 1)
- Chord 4: A-flat (4 1 3 2)

sleep in heav - en - ly peace, sleep in heav - en - ly peace.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born."
Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born.